GRADE 4

Curriculum Book

Businesses need a simple plan

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 4 - Curriculum Book

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Year theme: *Businesses need a simple plan* ***Band:*** *3-5 ·* ***Audience:*** *4th-grader · parent · teacher · admin*

Five answers, one page

The whole plan fits on one sheet of paper.

3-line elevator pitch

"A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one."

- CASH, GRADE 4

"Cash to Company fourth grade teaches your 9-year-old that a business idea isn't a plan until it's written down on one page. We add the 5 Reality-Check questions, the $50 budget cap, the 5-minute team meeting, and 'a little less wrong, every week.' Year 5 of a continuous K-12 mascot arc — gentle, evidence-based, never tells your kid 'you can be rich.'"

Parent-facing one-pager

TRY THIS

One question, five people

Pick the customer question from your one-page plan. Ask five real people in one day. Write each answer in one sentence.

What fourth grade covers

- **What is a plan?** — thinking, written down.
- **5 reality-check questions** — every plan must survive them.
- **Who, exactly?** — the customer statement.
- **The $50 cap** — every budget is a trade-off.
- **The 5-minute team meeting** — three questions, done in 5.
- **Honest is good business** — the asterisk trick.
- **A little less wrong, every week** — revision as a virtue.
- **Plans are thinking, written down** — year-end synthesis.

Dinner-table earworms

- "*A plan is thinking, written down.*"
- "*A budget is a list of nos with a yes underneath.*"
- "*A little less wrong, every week.*"

Promise: never asks family money. Never promises wealth. Never pressures real ventures.

What to say when...

KID SAYS	YOU CAN SAY
"I made a plan but it's wrong."	"*Wrong is fine. What's the fix?*"
"Can I have $50 to start a business?"	"*What does your written plan say it would cost?*"
"Why is the asterisk so small?"	"*What did Cash say about asterisks?*"

Teacher-facing one-pager

WORDS TO KNOW

Plan
Five honest answers about how a business works.

Customer
The exact person you can name and describe.

Offer
What the customer gets, in plain words.

Pricing
What the customer pays, and why that number.

Test
The smallest real thing you can do to see if the plan works.

Year in 5 sentences

G4 teaches **planning as a thinking discipline.** Across 36 weeks, students write a one-page plan, run it through 5 reality-check questions, name a customer specifically, manage a $50 budget cap, run 5-min team meetings, analyze honest vs. misleading ads, and revise weekly. Cash V5 is the Cash fumble. Capstone: a one-page plan + a defense.

Standards

- CCSS-Math.4.NBT, 4.OA, 4.MD (multi-step word problems, money)
- CCSS-ELA.W.4.1, 4.4 (writing arguments)
- C3.D2.Eco.3-5.5 (intentional choices)
- CASEL: Self-Management, Responsible Decision-Making

Weekly rhythm

Monday Cash + Q · Wednesday work block (30 min) · Friday share-out (15 min).

The 8 Cash-video CTAs

1. **V1 (W1)** One-page plan: WHO, WHAT, HOW, HOW MUCH.
2. **V2 (W9)** 5 Reality-Check Questions on your plan.
3. **V3 (W14)** Customer Statement: "My customer is ___ who needs ___ because ___."
4. **V4 (W21)** $50 budget worksheet: 3 musts / 3 wants / 3 nots.
5. **V5 (W29)** 5-minute team meeting (Cash fumble V).
6. **V6 (W24)** Real ad — find the asterisk.
7. **V7 (W32)** Weekly revision journal entry.
8. **V8 (W36)** Year-end pitch: 60 sec, one page.

What to say when...

- "*I don't want to write.*" — "*You don't have to write the whole thing. Just one sentence under WHO.*"

- *"My family doesn't have $50." — "This is a hypothetical $50, not real money. Practice with pretend numbers."*

Admin pitch outline

MATH MOMENT

How many a week?

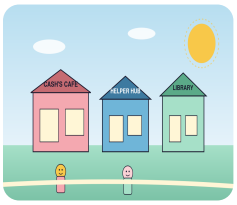
If you sold 3 a day for 5 days, how many is that? If each one costs $2 to make and sells for $5, what's left?

1. **Outcomes:** every G4 student writes a one-page plan defended through 5 reality-check questions, names a specific customer, manages a $50 hypothetical budget, runs a 5-minute structured team meeting, and produces a weekly revision journal.
2. **Standards:** CCSS-Math 4.NBT/4.OA/4.MD, ELA.W.4.1/4.4, C3.D2.Eco. 3-5.5, CASEL.
3. **Equity:** no family-money; printable; equity-by-design.
4. **Evidence:** Fall 2026 pilot.
5. **Differentiator:** Continuous K-12 mascot arc; Capstone progression every year. JA is event-shaped; we are routine-shaped. EVERFI is sponsor-funded; we have no sponsor.

Hashtag bank (20)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real answers

Read each plan answer to a different person. Write what they say back, exactly. That's data.

#CashToCompany #LearnWithCash #CashSays #FourthGrade #4thGrade #4thGradeTeacher #TeachersOfInstagram #TeacherTok #TeachersFollowTeachers #FinLitTeacher #FinancialLiteracy #ParentingTok #DinnerTableQuestions #NoHustleParenting #PlanningForKids #CustomerStatement #FiveQuestions #ALittleLessWrong #3-5Curriculum #WhichPeopleAndHowDoYouKnow

Sample social posts

FAMILY TALK

Five honest answers

Read your one-page plan to a family member. Ask: 'Which answer sounds the least real to you, and why?' Listen, don't defend.

Kid-direct

1. "*My fourth-grader's plan: 'A bracelet stand for kids who like cats.' Then she ran it through Cash's 5 questions. Plan #2 is way better. Tag your tiny planner.*"
2. "*$50 budget: 3 musts, 3 wants, 3 nots. My 9-year-old just told me 'rent is a must.' Cash to Company V4 is hitting.*"
3. "*Cash got it WRONG on purpose to teach the 5-minute team meeting. My kid is now critiquing every meeting I run from home. (Earned.)*"

Parent-direct

1. "*Evidence-based K-12 entrepreneurship curriculum that explicitly says 'we will not promise your child wealth' — Cash to Company. Currently making my fourth-grader write actual plans.*"
2. "'*A plan is thinking, written down' — my kid quoted this at me last night when I was rambling. Sometimes you build a curriculum, sometimes the curriculum builds you.*"
3. "*Cash to Company's 'Cash never says' list is the document I wish every kid-content publisher had. Pinned to the fridge.*"

Teacher-direct

1. "*5 reality-check questions on every G4 plan. Half my class realized their idea wouldn't survive question 3. That's the unlock.*" + V2 Short.
2. "'*A little less wrong, every week.' My fourth grade journal entries are now actually useful. Best week of the year.*"
3. "*$50 budget cap = the constraint that makes them think. Best 30 minutes of Wednesday.*"

FROM CASH

A plan is five honest answers

Who is it for? What is it? Why now? How much? How will I know it worked? Five lines. One page. Done.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 4 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Income - earning, planning, and tradeoffs.

CEE NS5
Roles of producers, consumers, and decisions.

CCSS-MATH 4.OA
Operations and algebraic thinking - model word problems.

CCSS-ELA W.4.2
Write to inform and explain - one-page plan.

CASEL Responsible Decision-Making
Identify problems, analyze situations.

C3 D2.Eco.2.3-5
Identify positive and negative incentives.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

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